

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Socialism, Fascism, Anarchism and Gandhism - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Socialism, Fascism, Anarchism and Gandhism

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 Orientation: Four Rival Responses to Modern Political Order | 2 Socialism: Definitions, Types and Democratic Reform |
| 3 Fascism: Doctrine, Leader Principle and Totalitarian State | 4 Fascism: Social Basis, Critiques and Gauba's Verdict |
| 5 Anarchism: Voluntary Order, Thinkers and Internal Strands | 6 Gandhism: Satyagraha, Trusteeship, Swaraj and Sarvodaya |
| 7 Four-Doctrine Synthesis, Traps and Answer Architecture | 8 Conservatism I: Burke, Oakeshott and the Four Pillars |
| 9 Conservatism II: Strands, Critiques and Comparative Change | 10 Conservatism III: Evidence, Indian Caution and Mark-Scaled Answers |

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Socialism, Fascism, Anarchism and Gandhism - Solved Practice Workbook	3
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	3
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	15
ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS	19

Socialism, Fascism, Anarchism and Gandhism - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g3 **PYQ ownership:** Every verified question below retains the primary owner recorded in the source ledger.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Evolutionary / democratic socialism**?

A. socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture. B. fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest, whereas Marxism makes class conflict central. C. Seeks socio-economic equality through public control. D. revolutionary trade unions and the general strike are the chief instrument of transformative struggle -> Named: Georges Sorel -> Significance: shows a route to radical change that stops short of full statelessness, complicating any simple socialism/anarchism binary (Gaub, PDF pp.76-77) -> Limitation: Gauba's own text notes Sorel is not a full-fledged anarchist, so citing him as straightforward "anarchism" misclassifies his position (§12.2).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Evolutionary / democratic socialism** with **socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture.**

A. Unit 3 - Claim B. Evolutionary / democratic socialism C. Warrant for change D. Socialism vs Marxism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture.** with **Evolutionary / democratic socialism.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Leader principle**?

A. fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider distribution of benefits to the masses. B. Accepts modern productive organization but regulates it. C. concentration of unconditional authority in a supreme leader/dictator whose will is treated as law, with the individual holding no rights against the state. D. love and non-obedience to immoral commands, not organized violence, should govern political relations -> Named: Leo Tolstoy -> Significance: supplies the clearest pacifist-Christian anarchist position and a widely attested influence on Gandhian non-violence (Gaub, PDF p.77; §12.3) -> Limitation: as a purely moral-individual position, it offers little institutional guidance for large-scale collective coordination.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Leader principle** with **concentration of unconditional authority in a supreme leader/dictator whose will is treated as law, with the individual holding no rights against the state..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **concentration of unconditional authority in a supreme leader/dictator whose will is treated as law, with the individual holding**

no rights against the state.

A. Unit 6 - Claim B. View of the state C. Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism D. Leader principle

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **concentration of unconditional authority in a supreme leader/dictator whose will is treated as law, with the individual holding no rights against the state.** with **Leader principle**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Socialism vs Marxism**?

A. socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution. B. most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically. C. Test whether fascism belongs with the other three as an "equality-seeking" critique of capitalism, and show why it does not (§13 verdict, §17 Chain 3). D. mutual aid and sociability, not competitive struggle, are the natural basis for cooperative order -> Named: Peter Kropotkin -> Significance: gives anarchism a positive, constructive account of how a stateless society could function, not merely a negative anti-state stance (Gauba, PDF p.75) -> Limitation: critics say it is over-optimistic about human cooperation at large scale (Gauba, PDF p.78).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Socialism vs Marxism** with **socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution.**

A. Accuracy limit B. Socialism vs Marxism C. View of inherited hierarchy D. Fascism vs liberalism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution.** with **Socialism vs Marxism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism**?

A. Gandhi's self-regulated order depends on moral discipline, not absence of social norms. B. Scale the number of doctrines/thinkers cited and depth of objection-reply chain (§19). C. one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism. D. do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism** with **one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism.**

A. Paternalistic / "one nation" B. Evolutionary / democratic socialism C. Fascism vs Marxism D. Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism**. with **Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Fascism vs liberalism**?

A. fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise. B. examples of democratic/evolutionary socialism that revise Marxist expectations about class conflict and political method. C. democracy can be redefined to include control over wealth production, achieved through existing constitutional machinery -> Named: Sydney Webb -> Significance: gives Fabianism a precise reformist mechanism distinct from revolutionary Marxism (Gauba, PDF pp.58-59) -> Limitation: relies on the patience and goodwill of gradual legislative majorities, which critics say can stall or reverse. D. Those with advantage owe obligation to those without; social division is itself a threat to order, so amelioration is a conservative duty, not a socialist concession.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Fascism vs liberalism** with **fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise.**

A. New Right (market + authority) B. Fascism vs liberalism C. Leader principle D. Fascism vs socialism/communism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise.** with **Fascism vs liberalism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Fascism vs Marxism**?

A. Seeks socio-economic equality through public control. B. revolutionary trade unions and the general strike are the chief instrument of transformative struggle -> Named: Georges Sorel -> Significance: shows a route to radical change that stops short of full statelessness, complicating any simple socialism/anarchism binary (Gauba, PDF pp.76-77) -> Limitation: Gauba's own text notes Sorel is not a full-fledged anarchist, so citing him as straightforward "anarchism" misclassifies his position (§12.2). C. fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest, whereas Marxism makes class conflict central. D. A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Fascism vs Marxism** with **fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest, whereas Marxism makes class conflict central..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest, whereas Marxism makes class conflict central.**

A. Warrant for change B. Socialism vs Marxism C. Anarchism vs disorder D. Fascism vs Marxism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest, whereas Marxism makes class conflict central.** with **Fascism vs Marxism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Fascism vs socialism/communism**?

A. fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider distribution of benefits to the masses. B. Accepts modern productive organization but regulates it. C. love and non-obedience to immoral commands, not organized violence, should govern political relations -> Named: Leo Tolstoy -> Significance: supplies the clearest pacifist-Christian anarchist position and a widely attested influence on Gandhian non-violence (Gaub, PDF p.77; §12.3) -> Limitation: as a purely moral-individual position, it offers little institutional guidance for large-scale collective coordination. D. Demonstrated malfunction of a particular arrangement.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Fascism vs socialism/communism** with **fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider distribution of benefits to the masses.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider distribution of benefits to the masses.**

A. View of the state B. Fascism vs socialism/communism C. Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism D. Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider distribution of benefits to the masses.** with **Fascism vs socialism/communism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Anarchism vs disorder**?

A. Test whether fascism belongs with the other three as an "equality-seeking" critique of capitalism, and show why it does not (§13 verdict, §17 Chain 3). B. mutual aid and sociability, not competitive struggle, are the natural basis for cooperative order -> Named: Peter Kropotkin -> Significance: gives anarchism a positive, constructive account of how a stateless society could function, not merely a negative anti-state stance (Gaub, PDF p.75) -> Limitation: critics say it is over-optimistic about human cooperation at large scale (Gaub, PDF p.78). C. most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically. D. A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Anarchism vs disorder** with **most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically.**

A. View of inherited hierarchy B. Fascism vs liberalism C. Lassalle and Bernstein D. Anarchism vs disorder

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically.** with **Anarchism vs disorder**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness**?

A. Gandhi's self-regulated order depends on moral discipline, not absence of social norms. B. Scale the number of doctrines/thinkers cited and depth of objection-reply chain (§19). C. do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that D. Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (§22.8 Chain 1).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness** with **Gandhi's self-regulated order depends on moral discipline, not absence of social norms..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gandhi's self-regulated order depends on moral discipline, not absence of social norms.**

A. Evolutionary / democratic socialism B. Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness C. Fascism vs Marxism D. Equality vs hierarchy

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gandhi's self-regulated order depends on moral discipline, not absence of social norms.** with **Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Lassalle and Bernstein**?

A. democracy can be redefined to include control over wealth production, achieved through existing constitutional machinery -> Named: Sydney Webb -> Significance: gives Fabianism a precise reformist mechanism distinct from revolutionary Marxism (Gaub, PDF pp.58-59) -> Limitation: relies on the patience and goodwill of gradual legislative majorities, which critics say can stall or reverse. B. Those with advantage owe obligation to those without; social division is itself a threat to order, so amelioration is a conservative duty, not a socialist concession. C. examples of democratic/evolutionary socialism that revise Marxist expectations about class conflict and political method. D. socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Lassalle and Bernstein** with **examples of democratic/evolutionary socialism that revise Marxist expectations about class conflict and political method..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **examples of democratic/evolutionary socialism that revise Marxist expectations about class conflict and political method.**

A. Leader principle B. Fascism vs socialism/communism C. Technology / economy D. Lassalle and Bernstein

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **examples of democratic/evolutionary socialism that revise Marxist expectations about class conflict and political method.** with **Lassalle and Bernstein**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Equality vs hierarchy**?

A. Seeks socio-economic equality through public control. B. revolutionary trade unions and the general strike are the chief instrument of transformative struggle -> Named: Georges Sorel -> Significance: shows a route to radical change that stops short of full statelessness, complicating any simple socialism/anarchism binary (Gaubu, PDF pp.76-77) -> Limitation: Gauba's own text notes Sorel is not a full-fledged anarchist, so citing him as straightforward "anarchism" misclassifies his position (§12.2). C. A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality. D. concentration of unconditional authority in a supreme leader/dictator whose will is treated as law, with the individual holding no rights against the state.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Equality vs hierarchy** with **Seeks socio-economic equality through public control.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Seeks socio-economic equality through public control.**

A. Socialism vs Marxism B. Equality vs hierarchy C. Anarchism vs disorder D. "Critically examine"

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Seeks socio-economic equality through public control.** with **Equality vs hierarchy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Technology / economy**?

A. love and non-obedience to immoral commands, not organized violence, should govern political relations -> Named: Leo Tolstoy -> Significance: supplies the clearest pacifist-Christian anarchist position and a widely attested influence on Gandhian non-violence (Gaubu, PDF p.77; §12.3) -> Limitation: as a purely moral-individual position, it offers little institutional guidance for large-scale collective coordination. B. Demonstrated malfunction of a particular arrangement. C. Accepts modern productive organization but regulates it. D. socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Technology / economy** with **Accepts modern productive organization but regulates it.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Accepts modern productive organization but regulates it.**

A. Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism B. Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness C. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) D. Technology / economy

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Accepts modern productive organization but regulates it.** with **Technology / economy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **"Critically examine"**?

A. Test whether fascism belongs with the other three as an "equality-seeking" critique of capitalism, and show why it does not (§13 verdict, §17 Chain 3). B. mutual aid and sociability, not competitive struggle, are the natural basis for cooperative order -> Named: Peter Kropotkin -> Significance: gives anarchism a positive, constructive account of how a stateless society could function, not merely a negative anti-state stance (Gaub, PDF p.75) -> Limitation: critics say it is over-optimistic about human cooperation at large scale (Gaub, PDF p.78). C. A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired. D. one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **"Critically examine"** with **Test whether fascism belongs with the other three as an "equality-seeking" critique of capitalism, and show why it does not (§13 verdict, §17 Chain 3)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Test whether fascism belongs with the other three as an "equality-seeking" critique of capitalism, and show why it does not (§13 verdict, §17 Chain 3)**.

A. Fascism vs liberalism B. "Critically examine" C. Lassalle and Bernstein D. Unit 1 - Claim

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Test whether fascism belongs with the other three as an "equality-seeking" critique of capitalism, and show why it does not (§13 verdict, §17 Chain 3)** with **"Critically examine"**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)**?

A. do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that B. Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (§22.8 Chain 1). C. Scale the number of doctrines/thinkers cited and depth of objection-reply chain (§19). D. fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)** with **Scale the number of doctrines/thinkers cited and depth of objection-reply chain (§19)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Scale the number of doctrines/thinkers cited and depth of objection-reply chain (§19)**.

A. Fascism vs Marxism B. Equality vs hierarchy C. Unit 2 - Claim D. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Scale the number of doctrines/thinkers cited and depth of objection-reply chain (§19)** with **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Unit 1 - Claim**?

A. democracy can be redefined to include control over wealth production, achieved through existing constitutional machinery -> Named: Sydney Webb -> Significance: gives Fabianism a precise reformist mechanism distinct from revolutionary Marxism (Gaub, PDF pp.58-59) -> Limitation: relies on the patience and goodwill of gradual legislative majorities, which critics say can stall or reverse. B. Those with advantage owe obligation to those without; social division is itself a threat to order, so amelioration is a conservative duty, not a socialist concession. C. socialism

pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture. D. fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest, whereas Marxism makes class conflict central.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Unit 1 - Claim** with **democracy can be redefined to include control over wealth production, achieved through existing constitutional machinery** -> **Named: Sydney Webb** -> **Significance: gives Fabianism a precise reformist mechanism distinct from revolutionary Marxism (Gaub, PDF pp.58-59)** -> **Limitation: relies on the patience and goodwill of gradual legislative majorities, which critics say can stall or reverse..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **democracy can be redefined to include control over wealth production, achieved through existing constitutional machinery** -> **Named: Sydney Webb** -> **Significance: gives Fabianism a precise reformist mechanism distinct from revolutionary Marxism (Gaub, PDF pp.58-59)** -> **Limitation: relies on the patience and goodwill of gradual legislative majorities, which critics say can stall or reverse.**

A. Fascism vs socialism/communism B. Unit 1 - Claim C. Technology / economy D. Unit 3 - Claim

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **democracy can be redefined to include control over wealth production, achieved through existing constitutional machinery** -> **Named: Sydney Webb** -> **Significance: gives Fabianism a precise reformist mechanism distinct from revolutionary Marxism (Gaub, PDF pp.58-59)** -> **Limitation: relies on the patience and goodwill of gradual legislative majorities, which critics say can stall or reverse.** with **Unit 1 - Claim**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Unit 2 - Claim**?

A. A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality. B. concentration of unconditional authority in a supreme leader/dictator whose will is treated as law, with the individual holding no rights against the state. C. revolutionary trade unions and the general strike are the chief instrument of transformative struggle -> **Named: Georges Sorel** -> **Significance: shows a route to radical change that stops short of full statelessness, complicating any simple socialism/anarchism binary (Gaub, PDF pp.76-77)** -> **Limitation: Gaub's own text notes Sorel is not a full-fledged anarchist, so citing him as straightforward "anarchism" misclassifies his position (§12.2).** D. fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider distribution of benefits to the masses.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Unit 2 - Claim** with **revolutionary trade unions and the general strike are the chief instrument of transformative struggle** -> **Named: Georges Sorel** -> **Significance: shows a route to radical change that stops short of full statelessness, complicating any simple socialism/anarchism binary (Gaub, PDF pp.76-77)** -> **Limitation: Gaub's own text notes Sorel is not a full-fledged anarchist, so citing him as straightforward "anarchism" misclassifies his position (§12.2).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **revolutionary trade unions and the general strike are the chief instrument of transformative struggle** -> **Named: Georges Sorel** -> **Significance: shows a route to radical change that stops short of full statelessness, complicating any simple socialism/anarchism binary (Gaub, PDF pp.76-77)** -> **Limitation: Gaub's own text notes Sorel is not a full-fledged anarchist, so citing him as straightforward "anarchism" misclassifies his position (§12.2).**

A. Anarchism vs disorder B. "Critically examine" C. Unit 6 - Claim D. Unit 2 - Claim

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **revolutionary trade unions and the general strike are the chief instrument of transformative struggle** -> **Named: Georges Sorel** -> **Significance: shows a route to radical change that stops short of full statelessness, complicating any simple socialism/anarchism binary (Gaub, PDF pp.76-77)** -> **Limitation: Gauba's own text notes Sorel is not a full-fledged anarchist, so citing him as straightforward "anarchism" misclassifies his position (§12.2).** with **Unit 2 - Claim**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Unit 3 - Claim**?

A. love and non-obedience to immoral commands, not organized violence, should govern political relations -> **Named: Leo Tolstoy** -> **Significance: supplies the clearest pacifist-Christian anarchist position and a widely attested influence on Gandhian non-violence (Gaub, PDF p.77; §12.3)** -> **Limitation: as a purely moral-individual position, it offers little institutional guidance for large-scale collective coordination.** B. Demonstrated malfunction of a particular arrangement. C. socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution. D. most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Unit 3 - Claim** with **love and non-obedience to immoral commands, not organized violence, should govern political relations** -> **Named: Leo Tolstoy** -> **Significance: supplies the clearest pacifist-Christian anarchist position and a widely attested influence on Gandhian non-violence (Gaub, PDF p.77; §12.3)** -> **Limitation: as a purely moral-individual position, it offers little institutional guidance for large-scale collective coordination..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **love and non-obedience to immoral commands, not organized violence, should govern political relations** -> **Named: Leo Tolstoy** -> **Significance: supplies the clearest pacifist-Christian anarchist position and a widely attested influence on Gandhian non-violence (Gaub, PDF p.77; §12.3)** -> **Limitation: as a purely moral-individual position, it offers little institutional guidance for large-scale collective coordination.**

A. Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness B. Unit 3 - Claim C. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) D. Accuracy limit

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **love and non-obedience to immoral commands, not organized violence, should govern political relations** -> **Named: Leo Tolstoy** -> **Significance: supplies the clearest pacifist-Christian anarchist position and a widely attested influence on Gandhian non-violence (Gaub, PDF p.77; §12.3)** -> **Limitation: as a purely moral-individual position, it offers little institutional guidance for large-scale collective coordination.** with **Unit 3 - Claim**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Unit 6 - Claim**?

A. A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired. B. one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism. C. mutual aid and sociability, not competitive struggle, are the natural basis for cooperative order -> **Named: Peter Kropotkin** -> **Significance: gives anarchism a positive, constructive account of how a stateless society could function, not merely a negative anti-state stance (Gaub, PDF p.75)** -> **Limitation: critics say it is over-optimistic about human cooperation at large scale (Gaub, PDF p.78).** D. Gandhi's self-regulated order depends on moral discipline, not absence of social norms.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Unit 6 - Claim** with **mutual aid and sociability, not competitive struggle, are the natural basis for cooperative order** -> **Named: Peter Kropotkin** -> **Significance: gives anarchism a positive, constructive account of how a stateless society could function, not merely a negative anti-state stance (Gaub, PDF p.75)** -> **Limitation: critics say it is over-optimistic about human cooperation at large scale (Gaub, PDF p.78)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **mutual aid and sociability, not competitive struggle, are the natural basis for cooperative order** -> **Named: Peter Kropotkin** -> **Significance: gives anarchism a positive, constructive account of how a stateless society could function, not merely a negative anti-state stance (Gaub, PDF p.75)** -> **Limitation: critics say it is over-optimistic about human cooperation at large scale (Gaub, PDF p.78)**.

A. Lassalle and Bernstein B. Unit 1 - Claim C. Paternalistic / "one nation" D. Unit 6 - Claim

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **mutual aid and sociability, not competitive struggle, are the natural basis for cooperative order** -> **Named: Peter Kropotkin** -> **Significance: gives anarchism a positive, constructive account of how a stateless society could function, not merely a negative anti-state stance (Gaub, PDF p.75)** -> **Limitation: critics say it is over-optimistic about human cooperation at large scale (Gaub, PDF p.78)**. with **Unit 6 - Claim**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Accuracy limit**?

A. do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that B. Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (§22.8 Chain 1). C. fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise. D. examples of democratic/evolutionary socialism that revise Marxist expectations about class conflict and political method.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Accuracy limit** with **do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that**

A. Equality vs hierarchy B. Accuracy limit C. Unit 2 - Claim D. New Right (market + authority)

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that** with **Accuracy limit**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Paternalistic / "one nation"**?

A. socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture. B. fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest, whereas Marxism makes class conflict central. C. Those with advantage owe obligation to those without; social division is itself a threat to order, so amelioration is a conservative duty, not a socialist concession. D. Seeks socio-economic equality through public control.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Paternalistic / "one nation"** with **Those with advantage owe obligation to those without; social division is itself a threat to order, so amelioration is a conservative duty, not a socialist concession..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Those with advantage owe obligation to those without; social division is itself a threat to order, so amelioration is a conservative duty, not a socialist concession.**

A. Technology / economy B. Unit 3 - Claim C. Warrant for change D. Paternalistic / "one nation"

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Those with advantage owe obligation to those without; social division is itself a threat to order, so amelioration is a conservative duty, not a socialist concession.** with **Paternalistic / "one nation"**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **New Right (market + authority)**?

A. A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality. B. concentration of unconditional authority in a supreme leader/dictator whose will is treated as law, with the individual holding no rights against the state. C. fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider distribution of benefits to the masses. D. Accepts modern productive organization but regulates it.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **New Right (market + authority)** with **A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality.**

A. "Critically examine" B. New Right (market + authority) C. Unit 6 - Claim D. View of the state

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality.** with **New Right (market + authority)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Warrant for change**?

A. socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution. B. most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically. C. Demonstrated malfunction of a particular arrangement. D. Test whether fascism belongs with the other three as an "equality-seeking" critique of capitalism, and show why it does not (§13 verdict, §17 Chain 3).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Warrant for change** with **Demonstrated malfunction of a particular arrangement..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Demonstrated malfunction of a particular arrangement.**

A. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) B. Accuracy limit C. View of inherited hierarchy D. Warrant for change

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Demonstrated malfunction of a particular arrangement.** with **Warrant for change.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **View of the state**?

A. A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired. B. one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism. C. Gandhi's self-regulated order depends on moral discipline, not absence of social norms. D. Scale the number of doctrines/thinkers cited and depth of objection-reply chain (§19).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **View of the state** with **A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired.**

A. Unit 1 - Claim B. View of the state C. Paternalistic / "one nation" D. Evolutionary / democratic socialism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired.** with **View of the state.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **View of inherited hierarchy**?

A. fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise. B. examples of democratic/evolutionary socialism that revise Marxist expectations about class conflict and political method. C. Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (§22.8 Chain 1). D. democracy can be redefined to include control over wealth production, achieved through existing constitutional machinery -> Named: Sydney Webb -> Significance: gives Fabianism a precise reformist mechanism distinct from revolutionary Marxism (Gauba, PDF pp.58-59) -> Limitation: relies on the patience and goodwill of gradual legislative majorities, which critics say can stall or reverse.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **View of inherited hierarchy** with **Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (§22.8 Chain 1).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (§22.8 Chain 1).**

A. Unit 2 - Claim B. New Right (market + authority) C. Leader principle D. View of inherited hierarchy

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (§22.8 Chain 1).** with **View of inherited hierarchy.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Ownership note: These are verified Philosophy Optional Paper II questions. Their primary owner remains the Philosophy Political Ideologies corpus; they are reproduced here only where the Political Theory topic supplies the directly tested doctrine.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: Do you subscribe to the political ideology of Anarchists ? Justify your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. I subscribe to anarchism's CRITIQUE -- its refusal to identify order with sovereign command and its demand that coercive authority justify itself function by function -- but not to the strong CONSTRUCTIVE claim that a complex modern society can dispense with all public authority; the defensible position is philosophical, not insurrectionary, anarchism.

- **The doctrine, exactly.** Anarchism holds that coercive political authority, paradigmatically the sovereign state, lacks adequate moral justification, and that order can rest on voluntary association, mutual aid and federation. Its engine is the burden-of-justification argument: legitimate authority must respect autonomy and equality (1); the state claims a territorial monopoly of law and coercion (2); it demands obedience for a command's LEGALITY, not its rightness (3); that subordinates my judgment to another's institutional will (4); so the state bears a burden it cannot discharge (5).
 - **Why I accept the critique (evidence P9).** Property and the state can function as an institutional power of appropriation and domination (Proudhon), and concentrated power deforms ruler and ruled (Bakunin), while cooperation and mutual aid are genuine sources of order (Kropotkin). Historical existence is not moral legitimacy.
 - **Why I stop short (objection -> reply -> residual).** Objection: without public authority, scale, public goods and persistent aggressors go unaddressed. Reply: anarchism rejects DOMINATION, not coordination -- delegated, recallable, federated administration can operate across scales. Residual: the HIDDEN-AUTHORITY problem is unanswered -- expertise, status and economic power return after formal offices are abolished, so a society still needs accountable public power to check them.
- Verdict (asymmetric).** Anarchism's critique of unaccountable coercion is stronger than its account of the order that should replace the state; I subscribe to its standard -- that authority is legitimate only so far as it is justified, limited and accountable -- while holding that the standard is best met by constitutionalised public authority, not by its abolition.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it answers "do you subscribe?" with a graded yes/no (accept the critique via P9, reject the strong constructive claim via the hidden-authority residual) and closes on the asymmetric verdict, not a slogan.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2019 Q1(c), 10 marks

Question: Evaluate Mahatma Gandhi as a political anarchist.

Model solution

Thesis. Gandhi is a QUALIFIED political anarchist: a moral and decentralist anarchist in IDEAL, but a pragmatic reformer in political METHOD -- so he shares anarchism's suspicion of the centralised coercive state without sharing its insurrectionary anti-theism or class war.

- **The anarchist affinity.** Gandhi's self-rule (*swarāj*) begins with rule over oneself; political freedom is insecure without mastery of desire, non-violence and local self-government. His preference for decentralised village republics and a state reduced to a minimum places him squarely within the anarchist family's rejection of concentrated coercive authority.
- **Where he diverges (evidence P10).** His non-violence, trusteeship, religious

ethics and constructive programme REPLACE class war and anti-theism; means must prefigure ends, so a violent, centralising path cannot produce a non-violent, decentralised order. This is a moral anarchism of transformation, not a Bakuninite programme of abolition.

- **The critical qualification.** Gandhi does not call for insurrection against the state; he accepts a minimal state and works through mass civil action and constructive reform. So his anarchism is an ideal-limit, approached by moral and institutional transformation, not a demand to abolish authority now.

Verdict. Evaluated as a political anarchist, Gandhi qualifies in aspiration -- decentralised self-rule/swarāj, minimal state, distrust of coercive centralism -- but not in method, since he pursues the ideal through non-violence and reform rather than the abolition of the state; "anarchist in ideal, reformer in method" is the exact formula.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it grades the label (affinity via self-rule/swarāj/minimal state; divergence via P10 means-ends and non-violence) and lands the precise "ideal vs method" verdict instead of a flat yes or no.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2020 Q1(e), 10 marks

Question: Do you think that the prevailing pandemic will lead to anarchism in society? Discuss.

Model solution

Thesis. No -- a pandemic does not "lead to anarchism", because anarchism is not the breakdown of order but a normative doctrine of order WITHOUT sovereign coercion; a crisis may produce temporary ANARCHY (disorder) or, revealingly, a surge of voluntary MUTUAL AID, but neither amounts to the considered political ideology.

- **The decisive distinction.** Anarchy is the absence or collapse of effective rule and may mean disorder; anarchism is a critique of domination that PROPOSES non-coercive order through association, mutual aid and federation. Conflating the two is the exact trap the stem sets.

- **What a pandemic actually shows (evidence P9, used carefully).** Emergencies simultaneously (a) expand STATE authority (public-health coercion, mobilisation) and (b) reveal dense VOLUNTARY cooperation -- neighbourhood networks, community kitchens, mutual-aid groups -- which illustrate Kropotkin's claim that mutual aid is a genuine source of social order, not an accidental exception. But such networks show limited, local capacities; they do not prove a complex society can eliminate public authority.

- **Objection -> reply.** Objection: crisis distrust of the state could snowball into anti-statism. Reply: distrust of a particular government is not the principled anarchist rejection of the state as such; and pandemics typically strengthen demands FOR competent public authority, not for its abolition.

Verdict. A pandemic may generate episodes of anarchy and impressive mutual aid, but it does not generate anarchISM; if anything it displays BOTH the indispensability of accountable public authority AND the real, bounded power of voluntary cooperation -- which is the anarchist insight without the anarchist conclusion.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it refuses the anarchy/anarchism conflation up front, reads the pandemic through P9 (mutual aid, bounded), and grades to "shows the insight, not the conclusion" rather than answering a careless yes.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2021 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: Discuss anarchism as a political ideology. Is it possible to dispense with political authority completely? Give reasons for your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. Anarchism is a coherent political ideology built on a single powerful argument -- that coercive authority must justify itself and cannot -- but it is NOT possible to dispense with political authority COMPLETELY in a complex society; the tenable conclusion is the abolition of unaccountable DOMINATION, not of all public coordination.

- **Anarchism as an ideology (the argument).** It diagnoses domination as flowing from coercive hierarchy itself and prescribes voluntary association, mutual aid and federation. The burden-of-justification argument runs in five steps (autonomy/equality -> the state's territorial coercion monopoly ->

obedience demanded for legality not rightness -> subordination of judgment -> unmet burden). Its strands differ on property and transition: mutualism (Proudhon), collectivist (Bakunin), anarcho-communism (Kropotkin), individualist and philosophical anarchism, which denies an automatic duty to obey without demanding insurrection.

- **The strongest case for dispensing with authority (evidence P9).** The state has historically organised war, repression and structural domination; federated, delegated and recallable administration can coordinate without a sovereign centre; so much "necessary" authority is really entrenched power.

- **Why complete dispensal fails (objection -> reply -> residual).** Objections: the security dilemma (private violence, persistent aggressors), scale and public goods, and above all HIDDEN AUTHORITY -- expertise, status and economic power return once formal offices vanish. Replies neutralise the first two (coordination is not domination). Residual: the hidden-authority problem is unanswered, and it requires accountable PUBLIC authority to police domination inside voluntary associations. Bakunin's own warning -- that a revolutionary state breeds a new elite -- cuts BOTH ways: unaccountable power returns whether it is called a state or not.

Verdict (asymmetric). Anarchism succeeds as a CRITERION -- authority is legitimate only so far as it is justified, limited, decentralised and accountable -- and fails as a total programme; we cannot dispense with political authority completely, but we can, and should, subject it relentlessly to that anarchist test.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it expounds anarchism as an argument with named strands, presses the strongest case (P9), then answers "completely?" through the hidden-authority residual and Bakunin's double-edged warning, closing on the asymmetric criterion verdict.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2021 Q3(b), 15 marks

Question: Discuss the distinctive features of Gandhian Socialism and its contemporary relevance.

Model solution

Thesis. Gandhian socialism is a distinctive NON-VIOLENT, DECENTRALIST socialism that seeks equality and freedom from exploitation without class war or centralised industrial collectivism; its contemporary relevance lies in its ethics of means-ends unity and ecological restraint, even as its central mechanism -- trusteeship -- remains institutionally fragile.

- **Distinctive features.** It combines non-possession, TRUSTEESHIP, bread labour, decentralised production, village self-rule (swarāj) and SARVODAYA (the welfare of all). Its argument: property carries a social obligation; production should meet need without degrading labour, community or nature; and the means must embody the non-violent end (evidence P10 -- means determine ends). It rejects BOTH unrestricted capitalism AND violent, centralised collectivism.

- **How it differs from Marxian socialism.** Where Marx locates the root in class exploitation and prescribes revolutionary transition, Gandhi locates it in greed, violence and modern industrial civilisation and prescribes moral transformation, trusteeship and constructive work; self-rule begins with ethical self-restraint, not seizure of the means of production.

- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: trusteeship depends on the voluntary moral conversion of owners and may simply preserve unequal ownership. Reply: Gandhi treats trusteeship as a non-violent DIRECTION of transition, not a celebration of possession. Residual: without enforceable institutions the objection stands -- Ambedkar's warning against relying on the conscience of the dominant is decisive, and Gandhian socialism needs institutional backing to be more than exhortation.

- **Contemporary relevance.** Its emphasis on decentralisation, need-based production, dignity of labour and non-violent means speaks directly to ecological limits, over-consumption and the alienation of scale -- a live corrective to productivism.

Verdict. Gandhian socialism is distinctive precisely in fusing equality with non-violence and decentralisation; it is contemporarily relevant as an ETHICAL and ecological critique, but delivers on that promise only when trusteeship is underwritten by enforceable institutions rather than left to conscience.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it names the trusteeship/self-rule (swarāj)/sarvodaya cluster, contrasts it with Marxian socialism, presses the voluntary-conversion objection to a residual (Ambedkar), and grounds relevance in means-ends + ecology.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2023 Q1(b), 10 marks

Question: Critically examine the anarchist's view that "all States always and everywhere are illegitimate and unjust."

Model solution

Thesis. The anarchist claim that "all States always and everywhere are illegitimate and unjust" states the doctrine at its strongest and most UNIVERSAL -- and that universality is also its weakness: the burden-of-justification argument shows the state must always JUSTIFY itself, but not that every state everywhere maximally FAILS to; the defensible core is philosophical anarchism, not this absolute.

- **Reconstruct the claim.** It rests on the five-step argument: legitimate authority must respect autonomy and equality; the state claims a territorial monopoly of coercion; it demands obedience for legality, not rightness; this subordinates individual judgment; therefore the state bears an unmet burden of justification (evidence P9 -- property/authority as institutionalised domination; Bakunin's thesis that concentrated power corrupts).

- **Why the UNIVERSAL form overreaches.** "Always and everywhere" collapses the distinction between a standing DUTY TO JUSTIFY and a verdict of GUILT. A liberal constitutional state that limits itself by rights, consent, accountability and the rule of law satisfies far more of the justification burden than an absolutist one -- so states differ in legitimacy by degree; a blanket "all... always" ignores that gradient.

- **The disciplined reply (philosophical anarchism).** The strongest anarchism is PHILOSOPHICAL: it denies an AUTOMATIC duty to obey the state simply because a command is legal, while allowing critical allegiance to institutions that earn it. That preserves the moral insight (no unearned authority) without the false empirical claim that every state is equally unjust.

Verdict (criterion). Judged by the justification of coercion, the anarchist is right that NO state is self-legitimizing and every state must answer for its coercion; but "all, always, everywhere, illegitimate" is too strong -- legitimacy is a graded achievement, and the tenable position is that authority is presumptively suspect until justified, not that it is universally condemned.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it "critically examines" by reconstructing the claim via P9, isolating the fatal word "always/everywhere", and rescuing the defensible philosophical-anarchist core with a graded criterion verdict.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2024 Q1(e), 10 marks

Question: Compare socialism and communism as two distinct political ideologies.

Model solution

Thesis. Socialism and communism are distinct ideologies, not synonyms: SOCIALISM names a broad family that subjects productive property to social control by many possible routes, while COMMUNISM (in Marxist vocabulary) names a specific END-STATE -- a classless, stateless order distributing according to need -- reached through a transition; the difference is one of scope, ownership regime, the fate of the state and the principle of distribution.

- **Run the shared axes in parallel (evidence P11).**

- **PROPERTY:** socialism = social control in varied forms (state, cooperative, market, moral); communism = common ownership with classes abolished.

- **STATE:** socialism may retain a democratic, active state; communism expects the political state, as an instrument of class domination, to lose its class function.

- **DISTRIBUTION:** socialism = by contribution, need or a mix; communism (higher phase) = according to need, once the "bourgeois" measure of contribution is transcended (evidence P12 -- equity is not equality; the lower phase still pays by contribution).

- METHOD: socialism = revolutionary OR gradual/parliamentary; communism = reached

through the transitional phase Marx calls the dictatorship of the proletariat.

- **The vocabulary caution.** In Marxist usage "socialism" often denotes the

transitional LOWER PHASE on the way to communism; in wider political theory it names the whole family. State which sense you are using, or the comparison collapses.

Verdict. They are distinct: communism is a specific classless, stateless, need-based end-state within the Marxist tradition, whereas socialism is the broader family of doctrines that socialise economic power by diverse routes and need not abolish the state at all -- so all communists are socialists, but not all socialists are communists.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it COMPARES on fixed axes (property/state/ distribution/method) via P11 and P12 rather than writing two summaries, flags the lower-phase/higher-phase vocabulary, and lands the "all communists are socialists, not vice versa" verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish democratic socialism from revolutionary socialism. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Both democratic and revolutionary socialism seek social control of production for common welfare, but they differ over method and institutional continuity.

Core analysis: Democratic socialism pursues gradual change through elections, legislation, administration, trade unions and public persuasion. Fabianism exemplifies this evolutionary strategy, while Lassalle and Bernstein revise revolutionary expectations in favour of constitutional reform. Revolutionary socialism holds that capitalist ownership and class power cannot be transformed adequately within existing institutions and therefore requires a decisive rupture. The disagreement concerns not the goal of overcoming exploitation alone, but whether the state and parliamentary system can become instruments of transition.

Critical evaluation: Democratic socialism reduces coercive risk but may be absorbed by capitalism; revolutionary socialism targets structural power more directly but risks authoritarian concentration.

Conclusion: Both seek social control of production, but democratic socialism treats constitutional reform as the route to equality whereas revolutionary socialism seeks a rupture with capitalist institutions.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why is anarchism a theory of non-coercive order rather than a defence of disorder? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Anarchism rejects the coercive authority of the sovereign state, not every rule, association or form of coordination.

Core analysis: Proudhon's mutualism envisages autonomous associations and reciprocal exchange; Kropotkin grounds cooperation in mutual aid and distribution by need; Bakunin favours revolutionary collectivism. These positions assume that social order can arise through voluntary federation, custom, reciprocity and democratically accepted obligation. Anarchists may also distinguish coercive command from expert authority, which is followed because of competence rather than a legal right to obedience. The doctrine is therefore a normative account of order without a coercive superior.

Critical evaluation: Its unresolved problems are scale, public goods, security and hidden informal domination. These challenge feasibility, but do not convert anarchism into a defence of chaos.

Conclusion: Anarchism rejects coercive sovereignty, not coordination itself; its viability therefore turns on whether voluntary association can meet the problems of scale, security and hidden authority.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Critically examine fascism as a political pathology rather than a coherent political philosophy. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Fascism is better understood as a totalitarian mobilisation of power than as a systematic and defensible political philosophy.

Core analysis: It combines extreme nationalism, hierarchy, the leader principle, single-party rule, myth over reason and violence as a political instrument. Mussolini's Italian fascism opposed liberalism, democracy and Marxism, while Nazism added an explicitly racial myth and should not be treated as identical in every respect. Fascism preserved concentrated capital while removing democratic and welfare restraints, destroyed plural institutions and reduced individuals to means of the total state. Liberal critics expose its destruction of rights; Marxist critics connect it with the defence of class domination.

Further development: The socio-economic debate sharpens the verdict. Laski views fascism as a rescue of capitalism through destruction of democratic rights and organised labour. McGovern and MacIver stress lower-middle-class insecurity, while Ebenstein links fascism to weak democracy, depression and fear. These explanations can coexist as mechanisms at different levels. Fascism's capacity to secure mass support does not supply normative justification; it shows how crisis, myth and organisation can convert insecurity into authoritarian mobilisation.

Critical evaluation: Its internal incoherence does not make it harmless: precisely because myth and authority replace rational justification, Gauba's description of political pathology is apt.

Conclusion: Fascism's cult of leadership, myth and violence can mobilise power, but its rejection of reason, liberty and equality prevents it from offering a defensible political philosophy.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate Gandhi as a moral and decentralist anarchist. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Gandhi has a strong anarchist affinity because swaraj ultimately means disciplined self-rule with the least possible dependence on coercive state authority.

Core analysis: His preferred order rests on decentralised communities, voluntary cooperation, ahimsa and satyagraha. Unlike Bakunin, Gandhi rejects violent insurrection and insists that means must embody the desired end. Trusteeship seeks to transform property into social stewardship, bread labour affirms the dignity of productive work, and Sarvodaya directs politics toward the welfare of all, beginning with the weakest. The moral discipline of citizens, not normlessness, sustains order.

Further development: The comparison with Tolstoy and classical anarchists clarifies the classification. Tolstoy's pacifist-Christian refusal of immoral commands influences Gandhi's moral anti-statism, while Proudhon, Kropotkin and Bakunin construct different institutional or revolutionary routes beyond the state. Gandhi adds disciplined non-violence, village self-government and a programme of social reconstruction. The qualification is decisive: he does not demand immediate abolition of every state function, and his economic transition relies more heavily on conversion and trusteeship than on coercive expropriation.

Critical evaluation: Gandhi is therefore anarchist in the regulative ideal of a self-governing society but pragmatic and reformist in political method. Trusteeship's dependence on moral conversion remains its major weakness.

Conclusion: Gandhi is anarchist in his ideal of self-rule and minimal coercion, but reformist in method because satyagraha and constructive work replace insurrection.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Compare socialism, anarchism, Gandhism and fascism on liberty, equality, state and property. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The four doctrines respond to modern capitalism and political authority through sharply different moral priorities.

Core analysis: Socialism seeks equality and common welfare through social ownership or control, with democratic and revolutionary variants differing over the state. Anarchism treats coercive authority as the principal domination and seeks voluntary federation, though its property positions vary. Gandhism combines self-rule, non-violence, trusteeship and decentralised production, making ethical means central to liberty and equality. Fascism instead subordinates the individual to the leader and total state, affirms hierarchy and preserves concentrated property under authoritarian control.

Further development: The transition mechanisms also differ. Democratic socialism uses constitutional state power to socialise control; revolutionary socialism seeks rupture; anarchism replaces sovereignty with voluntary federation; Gandhism uses moral self-rule, constructive work and non-violent resistance; fascism concentrates power in leader and party. Their treatment of property follows the diagnosis of domination: social control for socialists, varied mutual or communal arrangements for anarchists, trusteeship for Gandhi, and concentrated private ownership under political subordination for fascism. The comparison must therefore avoid the superficial claim that all anti-liberal doctrines are alike.

Critical evaluation: Socialism, anarchism and Gandhism can be compared as rival emancipatory projects. Fascism must remain the outlier because it rejects the equal moral standing that gives the other three their critical purpose.

Conclusion: Socialism, anarchism and Gandhism offer rival emancipatory responses to domination, whereas fascism is the outlier because it openly subordinates liberty and equality to hierarchy and the total state.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Critically analyse conservatism as prudential reform rather than resistance to all change. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Conservatism is a disposition to preserve an inherited order through cautious change, not a doctrine that every existing institution must remain untouched.

Core analysis: Burke's argument is that institutions embody accumulated experience, prescription and tacit social knowledge that abstract redesign cannot easily replace. Reform is justified when demonstrated malfunction threatens continuity: change is undertaken in order to conserve. Oakeshott adds an epistemic distinction between technical knowledge and practical knowledge embedded in tradition and judgment. Conservative strands nevertheless differ, from traditional hierarchy to paternalistic obligation and the market-oriented New Right.

Further development: The internal strands reveal the limits of a single definition. Traditional conservatism emphasises authority and inherited order; paternalistic or One-Nation conservatism adds obligations toward social cohesion; the New Right combines market liberalism with conservative themes, though Hayek explicitly rejected the conservative label. Paine's counterargument remains powerful: inherited prescription cannot bind successors or legitimate injustice. The conservative reply is strongest as an epistemic caution about unintended consequences, not as proof that existing hierarchy is morally right. In the Indian context, prudence cannot excuse caste exclusion merely because it is historically embedded.

Critical evaluation: Prudence can correct rationalist overconfidence, but it may also protect exclusion and inherited privilege. Conservatism is defensible only when gradualism remains open to evidence, rights and the claims of those

burdened by tradition.

Conclusion: Conservatism is most defensible when inherited institutions are treated as revisable stores of practical knowledge; it becomes indefensible when prudence is used to shield hierarchy or exclusion.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.